

W06 DRINKING WATER PROMOTION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Promote proper hydration through the consumption of drinking water over less healthy alternatives by promoting access to drinking water of verified quality.

Summary : This WELL feature requires readily available and maintained dispensers for drinking water.

Issue : People in many parts of the world do not hydrate enough to meet health guidelines, even in places where drinking water is available at the tap such as the U.S., Europe and Australia.¹⁻³ Conversely, increased amounts of water consumption has been connected with better diet quality.²⁻⁴ Despite being relatively cheap and being shown to attenuate socioeconomic disparities in hydration,⁵ the public's negative perceptions about the quality of tap water has catalyzed the adoption of bottled water. While plastic bottled water allows for portable hydration, excess waste produced by the dumping and degradation of single-use bottles and the generation of microplastics is a serious environmental concern. Pollution produced by single use plastic products is a rising public health issue that requires a comprehensive toxicological assessment in order to understand its full impact.⁶

Solutions : The first step toward increasing consumption of good quality water is to make it easily available and removing barriers to accessibility. When the addition of drinking fountains is combined with information sessions, consumption of plain water has been found to increase.⁷ Finally, it is important to keep water dispensers in a state of good repair to encourage continued water consumption.⁸ Using drinking water fixtures also allows fresh water to run through pipes, preventing losses in water quality.⁹

PART 1 ENSURE DRINKING WATER ACCESS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

1: Dispenser availability

The following requirements are met:

- At least one drinking water dispenser on each floor that includes regularly occupied space is located within a 30 m walk distance of all regularly occupied floor area and in all dining areas (except in areas where the presence of drinking water dispensers is forbidden by building codes or applicable regulations).
- Water delivered by the dispensers is directly piped through the building's water supply or is stored in containers designed for refilling.
- All newly installed drinking water fountains are designed for water bottle-refilling.

2: Dispenser maintenance

All drinking water dispensers meet the following requirement:

- The mouthpieces/outlets, protective guards, aerators (if present), basins and touch points are cleaned on a daily basis.

REFERENCES

- Malisova O, Athanasatou A, Pepa A, et al. Water Intake and Hydration Indices in Healthy European Adults: The European Hydration Research Study (EHRS). *Nutrients*. 2016;8(4).
- Sui Z, Zheng M, Zhang M, Rangan A. Water and Beverage Consumption: Analysis of the Australian 2011-2012 National Nutrition and Physical Activity Survey. *Nutrients*. 2016;8(11).
- Kenney EL, Long MW, Craddock AL, Gortmaker SL. Prevalence of Inadequate Hydration Among US Children and Disparities by Gender and Race/Ethnicity: National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey, 2009–2012. *American Journal of Public Health*. 2015;105(8):e113-e118.
- Gazan R, Sondey J, Maillot M, Guelinckx I, Luch A. Drinking Water Intake Is Associated with Higher Diet Quality among French Adults. *Nutrients*. 2016;8(11):689.
- Brooks CJ, Gortmaker SL, Long MW, Craddock AL, Kenney EL. Racial/Ethnic and Socioeconomic Disparities in Hydration Status Among US Adults and the Role of Tap Water and Other Beverage Intake. *American Journal of Public Health*. 2017;107(9):1387-1394.
- Picó Y, Barceló D. Analysis and Prevention of Microplastics Pollution in Water: Current Perspectives and Future Directions. *ACS Omega*. 2019;4(4):6709-6719.
- Jasper C, Le T-T, Bartram J. Water and Sanitation in Schools: A Systematic Review of the Health and Educational Outcomes. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*. 2012;9(8):2772-2787.
- Patel AI, Bogart LM, Uyeda KE, Rabin A, Schuster MA. Perceptions about availability and adequacy of drinking water in a large California school district. *Prev Chronic Dis*. 2010;7(2):A39-A39.
- Ling F, Whitaker R, LeChevallier MW, Liu W-T. Drinking water microbiome assembly induced by water stagnation. *The ISME Journal*. 2018;12(6):1520-1531.